



DREAMY DISH
Designed in 1853 by Irish sculptor W. B. Kirk, this porcelain fruit bowl is part of a Shakespeare dessert service. Each piece was decorated with a lively scene from *A Midsummer Night's Dream*.

Shakespeare's legacy

"HE WAS NOT OF AN AGE, BUT FOR ALL TIME," wrote the playwright Ben Jonson to describe his friend William Shakespeare, and he has been proved right. Over the years, styles of acting and staging plays have changed many times, but Shakespeare has not gone out of fashion. His plays have been translated into almost every language and are still being performed all around the world. They have inspired ballets, operas, musicals, films, and paintings. Shakespeare's other great legacy is to the English language itself. Hundreds of everyday words and phrases appeared first in a Shakespeare play. These include "bare-faced," "cold-blooded," "excitement," and "fair play." We all regularly quote from Shakespeare without realizing it.

Herbert Beerbohm Tree as Cardinal Wolsey in *Henry VIII*



SPECTACULAR SHAKESPEARE
British actor-manager Herbert Beerbohm Tree was famous for his spectacular productions of Shakespeare's plays in the late-19th and early-20th century. He used huge casts, lavish sets, and live animals. His dramatic style of acting was not to everyone's taste, but Shakespeare's characters can be played in many different ways.

CAPTURED IN GLASS

This stained-glass window depicting some of Shakespeare's comic characters is in Southwark Cathedral, London, where the playwright worshipped. The window was designed by Christopher Webb and was unveiled in 1954 on the anniversary of Shakespeare's death. Every year, on Shakespeare's birthday, a celebration of his life and works is held in the aisle beneath the window.



CARTOON CULTURE

In the 1990s, some of Shakespeare's plays were animated for children's television. In this scene from *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, the fairy king Oberon is pictured as he is about to awaken Titania from a spell. He touches her eyes with the magic herb, saying, "Now my Titania; wake you, my sweet queen."

